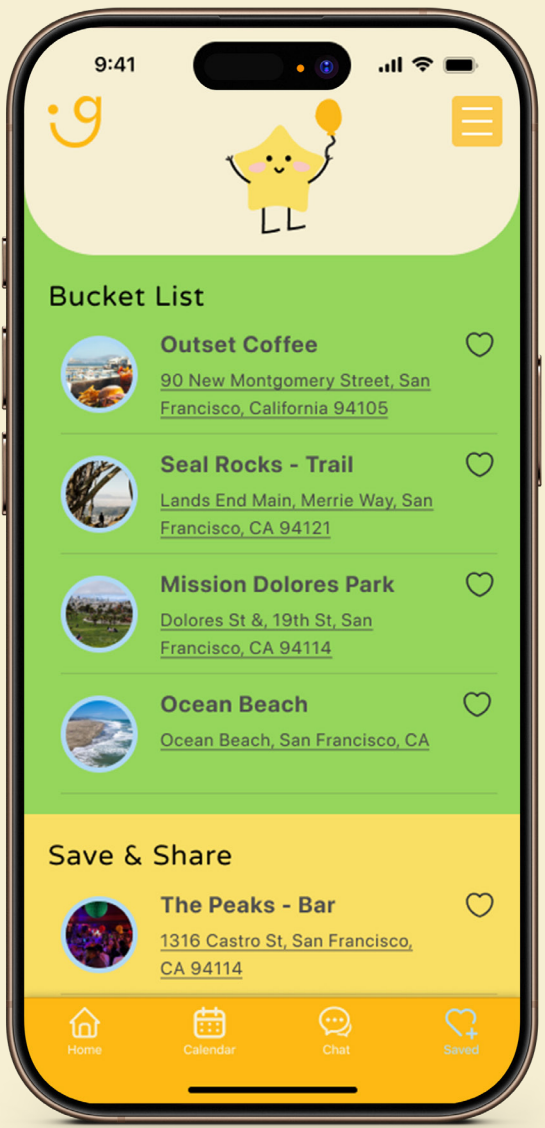
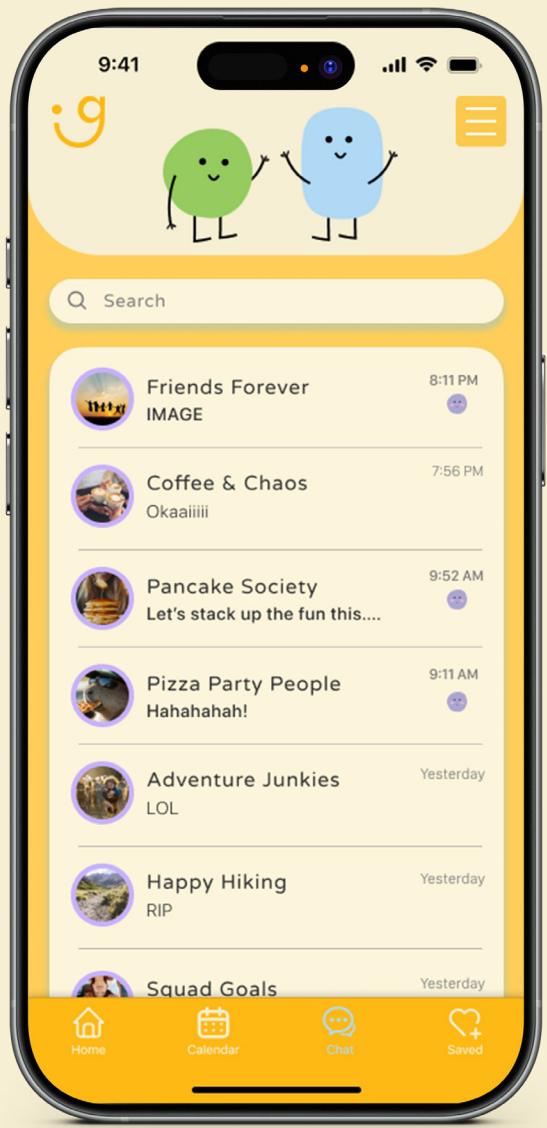
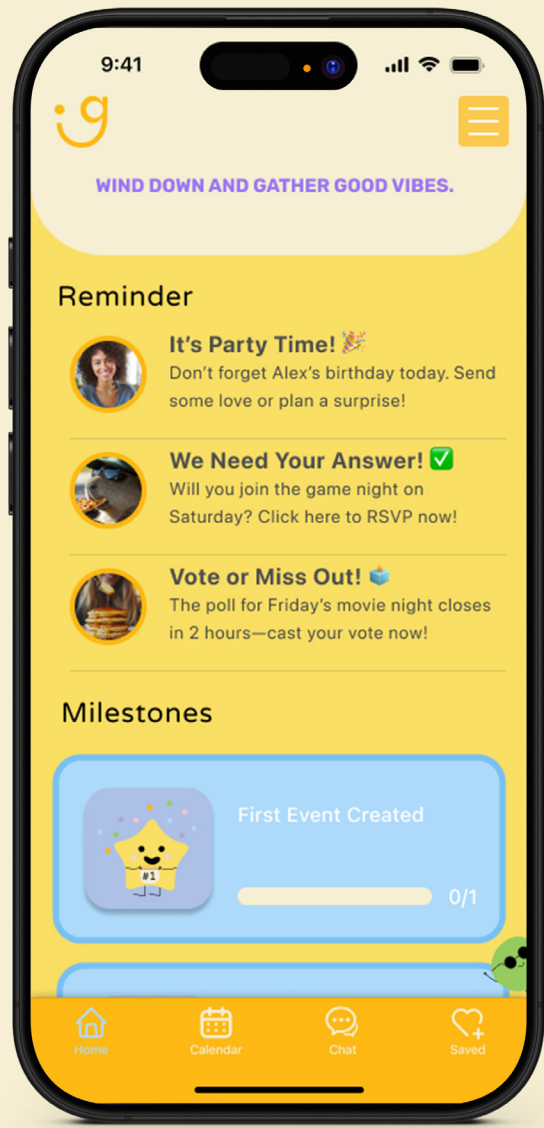




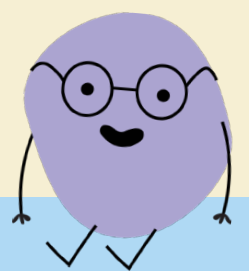
Life's Better When We Gather.

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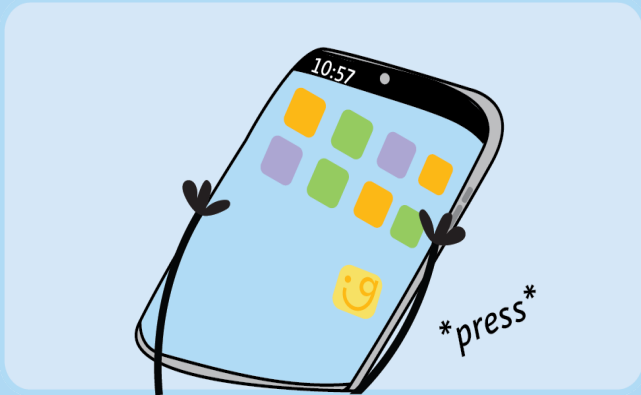
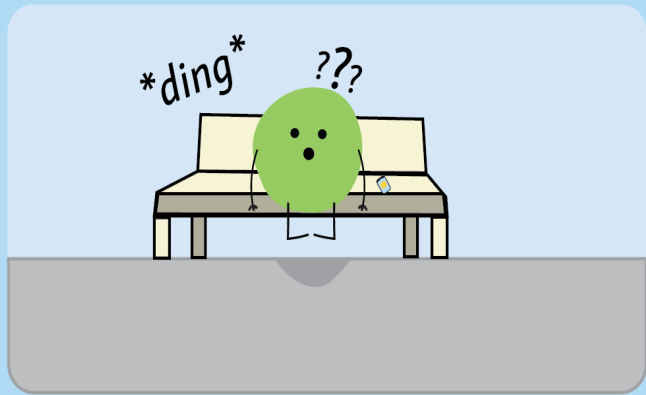
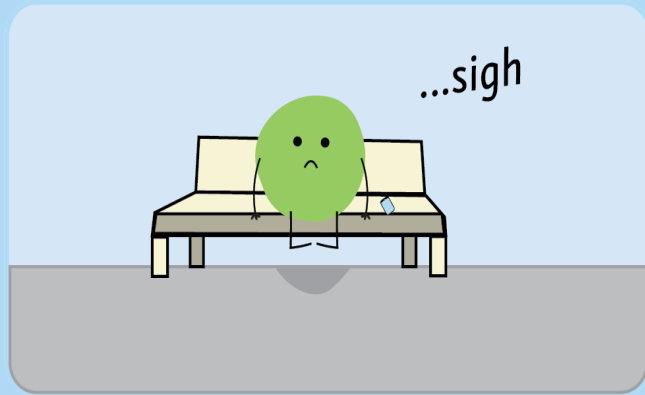
Product Description

Gather is an app designed for friends to stay connected despite busy schedules. It lets you easily share and view availability, helping you find the perfect time to meet up. Add your interests and places you'd like to visit, making planning activities more fun and effortless. Stay in touch through messaging and group chats, ensuring you're always on the same page. Gather simplifies making time for the people who matters the most.



Design Rationale

Gather was designed to simplify connecting with friends despite busy schedules. The shared scheduling feature lets users quickly view availability, eliminating the usual back-and-forth. In order to foster meaningful interactions, users can save places and activities, making planning easier and more engaging. Integrated messaging and group chats centralize communication, so coordination is seamless. The app's simple, accessible interface ensures a user-friendly experience for all ages. Gather prioritizes time with friends, making it easier to stay connected in a busy world.



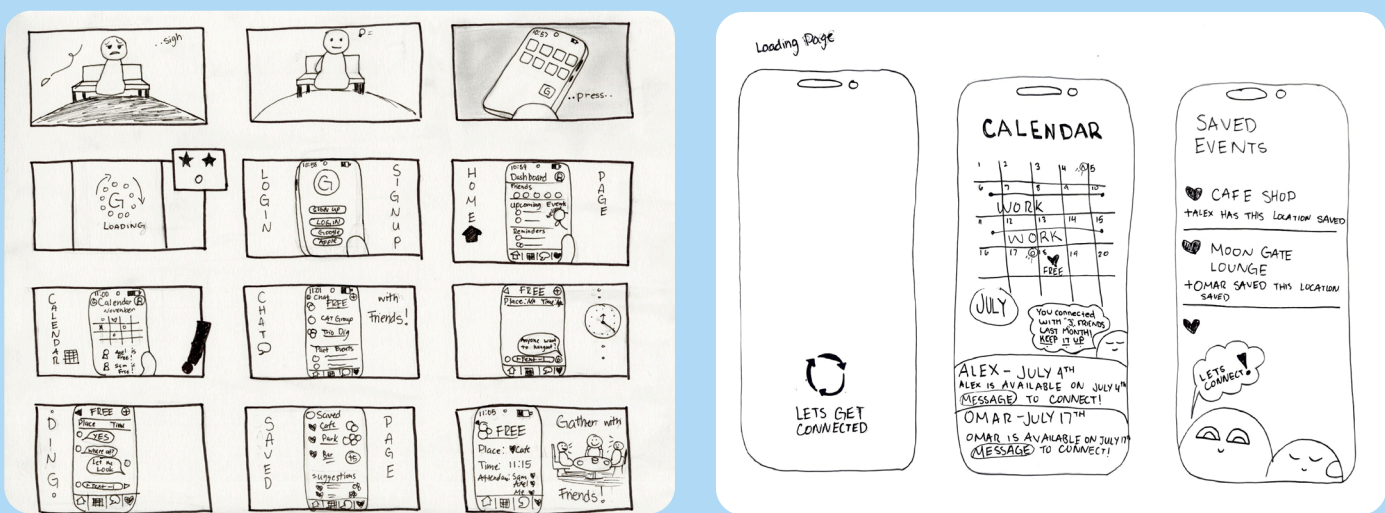
	Hedonia	Eudaimonia
M	-Playful and tactile elements like animations or vibrations provide instant sensory enjoyment. -Warm, bright colors that evoke friendliness and positivity, enhancing visual appeal and engagement.	-Tangible materials like intuitive UI and thoughtful design with friendly colors. -Time and data-driven insights help users visualize their availability and prioritize meaningful connections.
A	-Eye catching animations or celebratory graphics like confetti for a planned event to boost happiness. -Bright, inviting color palettes paired with friendly character designs to create a welcoming and delightful environment.	-Notifications that remind users of upcoming plans with friends provides a feeling of emotional connection. -Smooth transitions and micro-interactions that emphasize responsiveness and care, enhancing the user experience.
F	-Features like fun stickers, and instant scheduling options provide a sense of ease and joy. -Effortlessly connect with friends at a click, enabling seamless schedule viewing for quick and enjoyable planning.	-Enables users to create lasting relationships by prioritizing quality time with loved ones. -Offers personalized recommendations for available times and shared interests, simplifying the planning process.
B	-Milestones, rewards and motivate users, providing short-term joy. -Joyful chime when a friend connects with the other end user	-Encourages habits that align with values, like spending time with meaningful people. -Promotes mindfulness by helping users balance social and personal commitments for a fulfilling life.

	Captivation	Surprise	Lively	Cute	Serendipity	Reassurance
M	Responses or playful micro-interactions when friends have the same availability that keep users engaged.	-Discovery features, like a "Milestones" message. -Synced calendar data provides birthday and meetup availability.	Dynamic elements like animation characters for message notifications for schedule updates.	Soft, rounded UI elements; warm, pastel colors that evoke friendliness.	Unexpected yet delightful suggestions for meetups based on shared availability.	Secure and transparent handling of data, fostering trust.
A	-Themes that can be customized for personal flair. -Animated loading screen.	Pop-ups or badges showcasing milestones, like "You've planned 10 meetups this month!"	Motion graphics that bring attention to active areas of the app, like a bouncing animation on the calendar.	Adorable icons, rounded corners, and friendly typography.	Subtle design changes during certain events, like confetti animations when a goal is achieved.	Clean, easy to read layouts with gentle contrasts for accessibility.
F	-Elements planned meetups or badges for frequent social interactions. -Bucket list of events that are shared with your close friends.	Subtle design changes during certain events, like confetti animations when a goal is achieved.	Instant syncing and real-time updates that make interaction feel responsive and alive.	Option to send playful emojis or stickers to friends while scheduling or messaging in chats.	A notification highlighting overlapping free time or unexpected opportunities.	Clear, consistent feedback when actions are completed, like a confirmation message.
B	Evolving elements like mood-based UI themes or real-time responsiveness to user behavior.	Personalized surprises like a birthday countdown or a message celebrating friendship anniversaries.	Smooth, seamless transitions and animations that make using the app feel joyful and fluid.	Fun animations, like a heart fluttering when a plan is confirmed.	Automatic recommendations for unique activities (e.g., "You both are free—try a cafe nearby").	Notifications phrased warmly, e.g., "Your friend is looking forward to seeing you this weekend!"

Getting Informed

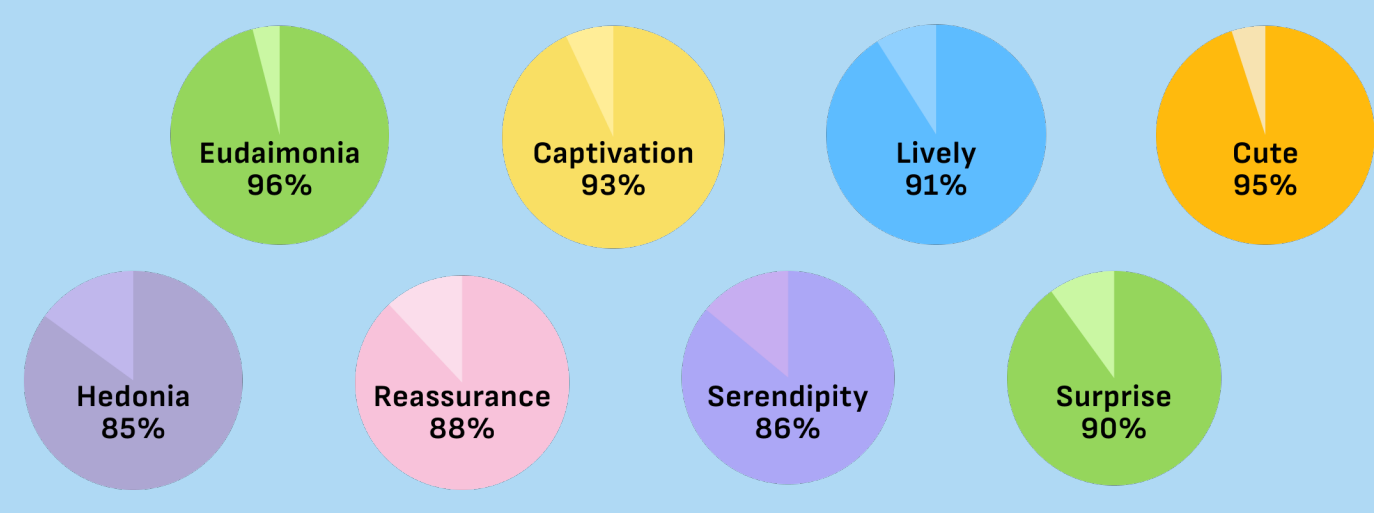
Evaluating 10 users provided us valuable insights into the apps overall impact on social planning and overall experience. All participants agreed that the app would significantly enhance their sense of security when planning out outings, helping them feel more confident about aligning schedules with friends. Additionally, users appreciated the ability to create moments of serendipity, enabling them to unexpectedly discover new hangout opportunities they might have missed otherwise.

The app's design was widely praised as being both fun and cute, adding a layer of joy to the scheduling process. Furthermore, participants highlighted how the app would make their social lives feel more vibrant and engaging, encouraging them to nurture their relationships and participate in more shared experiences. Overall, the evaluation confirmed the app's potential to enrich users' social connections while offering a delightful and practical tool for coordination.



Final Prototyping Phase and User Evaluation

After evaluating 10 users with our app iterations and storyboard, we designed the app based on our feedback. Based on our end user evaluation, our final product was successful and provided us with positive feedback on the overall user experience. All participants agreed that our app was intuitive and easy to use, meeting their needs and providing more opportunities to hangout with close friends. They appreciated the interactive and playful design, clear navigation, and the ability to accomplish tasks with minimal effort. Users highlighted that the app's calendar sync feature significantly enhanced their ability to manage their schedules efficiently and expressed satisfaction with its responsiveness and reliability. Additionally, participants noted that the app's aesthetic design and user-friendly interface made it enjoyable to use, further confirming its positive reception..



User Acceptance

The design was successful in proposing a tool to help a person live a better life. Hedonic and eudaimonic elements were both implemented in the app to provide enjoyment through its lively, cute, and engaging design while creating meaningful connections that enhance long term well being. The ability to simplify scheduling reduces the stress of planning outings with close friends. Having a simplified scheduling tool promotes serendipitous moments and creates a sense of vibrancy in one's social life. The app not only brings pleasure but also supports deeper fulfillment by encouraging intentional, valued social interactions, making it a tool for living both a more enjoyable and a more meaningful life.

Future Improvement

While we know Gather successfully enhances social planning and user engagement, there are some areas that can be refined in future iterations to improve its user experience. Users may benefit from having more customizable themes and ability to create an interface that is unique to their social habits. Another iteration would consist of ensuring that the app is inclusive for diverse users, including those with visual or motor impairments. Incorporating features like screen reader compatibility, high contrast modes, or voice input functionality would improve Gather's overall accessibility. These enhancements would not only make the app more engaging, but more versatile and inclusive.

Conclusion

The connection between delightful design and living a hedonic and eudaimonic life lies in the ability to balance instant pleasure with deeper fulfillment. A design that is captivating, surprising, cute, lively, serendipitous, and reassuring can spark joy and emotional engagement, aligning with hedonia. Along with creating meaningful connections and creating habits that align with personal values can create a sense of growth, aligning with eudaimonia. When a design is thoughtfully executed, delightful designs become more than just a functionality, it becomes a joyful experience and promotes a better well being.

